

Moses Yang

Hold My Hand

hold my hand
closer to your body after
you
 push
 me
out
 of
 you
into
 the
 world.

hold my hand
as I burst the bubbles
covering the lining of my lips
with my bibbling babbles
refusing to surrender control
to the mini fighter jet diving low
with target locked and ready to fire
but your comforting coos weaken my grip
as you grip my hand gently and
guide the plane to its landing strip

hold my hand
higher than I can reach
as I plant my feet firm
 shakely
stumbling forward about to land face first
arms swooping in like the seat of a swing
and root me in place
giving me the courage to run forward
and around
and towards you
to hug you

hold my hand
as you scold me
with tears streaming down both our faces
blotting the aged-gray carpet with blue stains of sorrow
I cried because
I cheated on my exams
and you were disappointed
in me and that hurt more than the ruler
on my hand and the bruises that followed
you cried because
your heart split in half and ha-
lf with every hit

hold my hand
as you teach me to cook with compassion
and sew with tenderness and love with intention
hoping one day your breathing touch
will live on through mine

hold my hand, mami
now covering yours
smaller than a starfish
but larger than love

hold my hand, mami
so we can walk together now
and

in another life.